



**AUSTRALIAN HIGH COMMISSION
NEW DELHI**

Australia is proud of its multicultural heritage. Since 1945, Australia has welcomed over 6.6 million migrants to Australia, including more than 690,000 through refugee or humanitarian programs. One of the key reasons that Australia attracted more than 500,000 students last year, drawn from 190 different countries around the world, is that they would be able to study in a truly welcoming, multicultural society.

Australia's leaders are therefore as appalled as I am by the injuries that some Indian students in Australia have suffered recently.

In the words of Australia's Prime Minister: "We are a multicultural nation and we respect and embrace diversity – diversity which has enriched our nation. That is why these recent acts of violence are all the more deplorable. They are equally unacceptable. And deserve to be met with the full force of the law."

Australia's Deputy Prime Minister, who is also the Minister for Education, said: "International students are very welcome in this nation and Australia will not tolerate discrimination against or victimisation of any international students."

So I can assure you that the Australian Government is working actively with the Government of India, both here in India and in Australia, to resolve this situation.

We are, for example, taking a number of practical steps that will further improve the experience of all Indian students who choose to study in Australia. One of these is the publication of the 3rd edition of the Australian Government's Guide to Studying and Living in Australia. We will be distributing 50,000 copies of this Guide to the members of the Association of Australian Education Representatives in India and asking that its members ensure that a copy is provided to each person who obtains a visa to study in Australia. A copy of this Guide will also appear on the Australian High Commission's website.

As the Guide's Introduction notes, a successful period of study in Australia is a two way compact. Education institutions in Australia are required to ensure that international students are provided with orientation briefings when they arrive in Australia and that they are provided with ongoing support during their period of study in Australia. Equally, international students should ensure that they are fully informed about studying and living in Australia. This 3rd edition of the Guide sets out the basics that international students need to know to succeed in their studies and life in Australia. The Guide has been expanded and improved to ensure that international students are provided with the best possible information about Australia.

The large numbers of Indian students who have already chosen to study in Australia have made an invaluable contribution to strengthening the people to people linkages between our two countries. Long may this strong interest continue.

John McCarthy
HIGH COMMISSIONER